



GST 104

NIGERIAN PEOPLE AND CULTURE

ULTIMATE MASTER EXAM NOTES
ALL 7 WEEKS · COMPLETE COVERAGE
Weeks 1-7 Consolidated
FUOYE · 2025/2026 Session

BY INDIGENE

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WEEK 1 — CONCEPTS OF NIGERIAN CULTURE AND CIVILISATION

1. Definitions: Civilisation vs Culture

CIVILISATION	CULTURE
From Latin CIVIS = "inhabitant of a city"	From Latin COLERE = "to till the soil"
Ability of people to live together harmoniously in cities/social groups	All positive aspects and achievements of humanity that make mankind different from animals
Includes arts, technology, sciences, religions, politics	Grows out of CREATIVITY — unique to humans
External achievements of a society	Inner values, beliefs, norms of a society
City of human beings at any stage of development	Constant and necessary companion of civilisation

MNEMONIC: CC = City & Cultivation. Civilisation = CITY life; Culture = CULTIVATION of mind/values

EXAM TIP: Civilisation and Culture are NOT the same — they are inseparable companions. Know the Latin roots!

2. Key Facts About Nigeria

- Location: West Africa, bordering Gulf of Guinea, between Benin and Cameroun
- Name origin: Suggested by British journalist Flora Shaw in 1914, influenced by River Niger
- Amalgamation: 1914 — Northern & Southern Protectorates merged by Sir Frederick Lugard
- Independence: October 1, 1960
- Republic: October 1, 1963
- Capital: Lagos (until 1991) → Abuja (1991–present)
- Population: ~170 million (largest Black population concentration in the world)
- Government: Federal system (replaced parliamentary system)
- First military coup: January 17, 1966 (counter-coup 6 months later)
- Civil War: 1967–1970 (Biafra)
- Oil ranking: 6th largest oil-producing nation in the world
- UN role: Largest contributor to UN and ECOWAS peacekeeping missions

MNEMONIC: NAIL: Name-Amalgamation-Independence-Lagos→Abuja

3. Religion in Nigeria

Religion	Region	%	Key Celebrations
Islam	North	~50%	Ramadan, Eid-ul-Fitr, Eid-ul-Adha; Friday worship
Christianity	South	~40%	Christmas, Easter (with Lenten fast); Sunday worship
Traditional/Indigenous	Nationwide	~10%	Ancestor worship, deities

Traditional Deities by Region:

Region	Deities
Eastern Nigeria	Amadioha, Aro, Okike, Anyanwu, Ikuku
South-West (Yoruba)	Ogun, Osun, Oya, Sango, Obatala, Egungun, Ifa oracle
Kogi State	Egbunu (Ebira), Ishepa (Igala), Egu (Nupe)

EXAM TIP: Christianity established in south Nigeria in late 19th century: Church of England (Yoruba SW) + Roman Catholic Church (Igbo SE)

4. Nigerian Society: Family, Hierarchy & Communication

Family Structure:

- Extended family is the BACKBONE of social system (grandparents, uncles, aunties, etc.)
- Family relationships guided by HIERARCHY and SENIORITY
- Social standing achieved through extended families
- Family honour influenced by members' actions

- Role of extended family diminishing in urban areas but tradition of mutual care remains

Hierarchy:

- Nigeria is a HIERARCHICAL society — age and position earn respect
- Oldest person in group is revered, greeted and served first
- Senior persons have responsibility to make decisions in best interest of group

Communication Styles:

Group	Communication Style
Yoruba (SW)	Use proverbs, sayings, songs; embed humour to prevent boredom; indirect
Southern Nigerians generally	More direct; slightly louder tone; emotional when passionate
General	Begins with informal enquiries about family/personal welfare (soft-landing)
Non-verbal	Parents use gestures; people smile to mask true feelings

5. Arts and Literature

- Nigeria's artistic heritage goes back MORE THAN 2,000 YEARS
- Nok Culture: Terra-cotta sculptures produced between 500 BC and AD 200 on Jos Plateau — EARLIEST notable pieces
- Ife bronzes: Dating from 13th century
- Benin: Bronze plaques, statues, ivory carvings from 11th century onwards
- Islamic influence in the North shaped architecture and calligraphy (no sculpture/representation of people/animals)
- Usman Dan Fodio: Founder of Sokoto Caliphate; wrote nearly 100 texts in Arabic
- Oshogbo School: Founded by Ulli Beier in early 1960s; explores Yoruba spirituality
- Zaria School: Late 1950s — synthesised traditional and modern themes
- Nsukka School: Early 1970s — known for strong social and political content

EXAM TIP: Nok = OLDEST. Ife bronze = 13th century. Benin = 11th century. Remember: NOK is FIRST!

1. Coat of Arms — Complete Breakdown

Element	What It Is	What It Symbolises
Red Eagle	Mounted on wreath in national colours	Nigeria's STRENGTH
Black Shield	Center of coat of arms	Fortuitous qualities of land: agricultural, mineral & solid resources
Y-shaped Silver Band	Wavy band in middle of black shield	River Niger + River Benue (the two major rivers)
Two White Horses	Support the shield on either side	DIGNITY
Coctus Spectabilis	Wild flower at the base	A flower that grows in many parts of Nigeria
Green Stripes	Two green vertical stripes	AGRICULTURE
White Stripe	Sandwiched between two green stripes	PEACE and UNITY; also symbolic of Niger River bisecting the country
Motto	Underneath all elements	"Unity and Faith, Peace and Progress"

MNEMONIC: EAGLE=Strength, SHIELD=Resources, Y-BAND=Two Rivers, HORSES=Dignity, GREEN=Agriculture, WHITE=Peace/Unity

EXAM TIP: The Y-band = River Niger + River Benue. The MOTTO = Unity and Faith, Peace and Progress

2. Nigeria's Political History Timeline

Period	Republic/Regime	Key Events & Leaders
1914	Birth of Nigeria	Northern & Southern Protectorates merged by Sir Frederick Lugard. Name "Nigeria" adopted
Oct 1, 1960	1st Republic begins	Independence from Britain. PM: Alhaji Sir Abubakar Tafawa Balewa
Nov 16, 1960	Governor-General	Dr. Nnamdi Azikiwe — first G-G. Federation of 3 regions (North, East, West). Capital: Lagos
Oct 1, 1963	Federal Republic	Nigeria severs ties with Britain; remains in Commonwealth. G-G redesignated President
Jan 15, 1966	1st Military Coup	End of 1st Republic; 8 military regimes followed
Aug 9, 1967	Civil War begins	Nigeria declared full-scale war on Biafra
1970	Civil War ends	Biafra collapsed; reconciliation period began. Oil Boom era
Oct 1979	2nd Republic	Shehu Shagari — first Executive President (National Party of Nigeria)
Dec 31, 1983	Military takeover	Maj. Gen. Muhammadu Buhari overthrows 2nd Republic. Launched "War Against Indiscipline"
Aug 27, 1985	6th Military Regime	Maj. Gen. Ibrahim Babangida ousts Buhari in bloodless coup
June 12, 1993	Annulled election	M.K.O. Abiola won but Babangida annulled. >100 died in riots
Nov 17, 1993	Abacha seizes power	Sani Abacha forces Shonekan's resignation
June 8, 1998	Abacha dies	Replaced by Gen. Abdulsalami Abubakar
May 29, 1999	4th Republic begins	Olusegun Obasanjo sworn in — ends 16 years of consecutive military rule
May 29, 2007	Yar'Adua	First peaceful civilian-to-civilian transition since independence
May 6, 2010	Goodluck Jonathan	Succeeds after Yar'Adua's death (May 5, 2010)
2015	Buhari (civilian)	Wins presidential election; reignites anti-corruption fight

MNEMONIC: Independence 1960 → Republic 1963 → 1st Coup 1966 → Civil War 1967-1970 → 2nd Republic 1979 → Buhari coup 1983 → Babangida 1985 → Annulled election 1993 → Abacha 1993 → 4th Republic 1999

EXAM TIP: KEY: Yar'Adua's 2007 swearing-in = FIRST time Nigeria transitioned from one civilian administration to another since independence!

WEEK 3 — PRE-COLONIAL CULTURAL LOCATIONS & CHARACTERISTICS

1. Early Human Habitation in Nigeria

- People lived in Nigeria (specifically Iwo-Eleru) as early as 11,000 BC
- Earlier evidence at Ugwuella-Uturu (Okigwe) in south-eastern Nigeria where microliths were used
- Earliest fossil human skeleton in West Africa — 13,000 years old — found at Iwo-Eleru, western Nigeria
- Smelting furnaces at Taruga dating from 4th century BC = oldest evidence of metalworking
- Iron Age: Kainji Dam excavations revealed iron-working by 2nd century BC
- Transition from Neolithic to Iron Age achieved WITHOUT intermediate bronze production

MNEMONIC: 11,000 BC = Iwo-Eleru. 13,000 yr skeleton = Iwo-Eleru. Taruga = Oldest metalworking (4th century BC)

2. The Major Pre-Colonial Empires/Kingdoms

Empire	Location	Period	Key Facts
NOK CULTURE	Jos Plateau, NE Nigeria	900 BC-200 AD	EARLIEST identified Nigerian culture. Earliest sub-Saharan producer of life-sized TERRACOTTA. Discovered 1928 (tin mining); 1943 (clay figurines found). Bernard Fagg = archaeologist who recognized importance. Iron smelting by 550 BC. Terracotta: hollow, coil-built, nearly life-sized human heads
SONGHAI EMPIRE	Northern Nigeria / West Africa	800 CE-1591	Settled at Gao as early as 800 CE. Capital established 11th century (reign of Dia Kossou). Sonny Ali = founded/enriched through brutality. Askia Mohammed Ture (Askia the Great) = brought Islam. Peak: Timbuktu = cultural & commercial centre. By 1500: covered 1.4 million sq km. Economy based on CLAN SYSTEM (clan determined occupation). Criminal justice based on Islamic principles; local Qadis. Assara-munidos = "enforcers" (police commissioners)
OYO EMPIRE	South-West Nigeria	14th c-late 18th c	Yoruba empire; most politically important state mid-17th to late 18th century. Founded by Oranyan (Oranmiyan), 2nd prince of Ile-Ife. Capital: Oyo-Ile (also known as Katunga/Old Oyo). Alaafin of Oyo = king ("owner of the palace"). Oyomesi = 7 principal councillors (like US Congress). Ogboni = powerful secret society; spoke for the people. Bashorun = head of Oyomesi; sort of Prime Minister. NOT hereditary; selected by Oyomesi. If Alaafin displeased, Bashorun gives parrot's egg = must commit suicide. Military success: powerful CAVALRY
BENIN EMPIRE	Edo State (South-East)	1440-1897	Founders: Edo people; originally ruled by Ogiso dynasty. Land called "Igodomigodo"; kings = Ogiso. Igodo = first Ogiso; good ruler. Oba Ewuare = first Golden Age Oba. Inner wall: 7 miles long, moat 50 feet deep (1,000 laborers). Rural walls 4-8 thousand miles long = 150 million man-hours. Advanced artistic culture: bronze, iron, ivory. FESTAC Mask = based on Queen Idia. Portuguese figures first appeared in Benin bronzes (16th century)
NRI KINGDOM	South-East (Igbo)	948-1911	West African medieval state of Nri-Igbo. UNIQUE: leader exercised NO military power. Administered by priest-king called the eze Nri. Founded by Eri (said to be a "sky being"). Eri settled region ~948 AD. First eze Nri = Ifikuánim (reign started 1043 per oral tradition). Expanded through converts, NOT force. Safe haven: slaves set free; outcasts welcomed. Best-known remnant: Igbo-Ukwu bronze items. 19 eze Nri recorded in 1911
KANEM-BORNU	NE of Lake Chad	9th-19th c	Bornu = initially western province of Kanem. Became independent in late 14th century

MNEMONIC: NOSoBN = Nok, Oyo, Songhai, Benin, Nri. From West to East: Songhai(N) → Oyo(SW) → Benin/Nri(SE)

EXAM TIP: Nok Culture = Terracotta + IRON. Benin = BRONZE + IVORY. Nri = NO MILITARY POWER. Oyo = CAVALRY + Oyomesi. Songhai = CLAN ECONOMY + Islamic justice

WEEK 4 — TRADITIONAL CONCEPT OF ECONOMICS, PEACE AND DEVELOPMENT

1. Concept of Peace in Traditional Africa

- In African Traditional Religion (ATR), peace is conceived in relation to ORDER, HARMONY and EQUILIBRIUM — NOT conflict/war
- Peace = DIVINE gift (not abstract/poetic concept — it is practical and down-to-earth)
- Peace is associated with RELIGIOUS, MORAL and SOCIAL values
- Peace transcends absence of conflict — includes absence of: pestilence, untimely death, poor harvest, unsafe journey, slave raid, sundry vices
- Definition of peace: Good relationship well preserved; health, absence of pressure and conflict, being strong and productive
- Peace = totality of well-being, fullness of life here and hereafter
- Mere possession of material wealth WITHOUT harmonious community relations = NOT peace
- Selfish/unjust persons (even when non-violent) = ENEMIES OF PEACE
- Promotion of LIFE is the central principle of African traditional understanding of peace

Sacred Peace Periods:

- Many African societies have specific sacred periods (up to a week or more) for peace promotion
- During this period: litigations suspended, quarrels/violence avoided (fear of gods' wrath)
- Sacred period often PRECEDES planting season — breach of peace = poor harvest

2. Wars and Conflict in Traditional Africa

- Wars were NOT fought for the sake of might
- Even with provocation, negotiation was FIRST attempted before armed conflict
- Robert Smith observed wars in pre-colonial Africa were mere SKIRMISHES — not real wars
- Wars were SUSPENDED during planting and harvest seasons
- Village square and King's yard meetings = common features for conflict resolution
- Resolution rituals: aggrieved parties drank palm wine from same calabash + shared kola nuts = symbolic end of impasse
- Traditional Africa viewed war as MORALLY UNACCEPTABLE (total collapse of social order)
- European slave trade, colonial conquest and globalization RAISED violent conflict to new dimensions

3. Concept of Development in Traditional Africa

- Justice → Peace → Development (in that order). Justice is prerequisite for peace; peace is prerequisite for development
- Development viewed as a DIVINE BLESSING — impossible to think of true progress in midst of disorder

Dimension	What It Means
Social/Moral	Maintenance of social order, sanctity of social justice and moral obligations
Economic	High yield on farm produce, hunting expenditures, profitable trade relations
Spiritual/Personal	Belief that ALL occurrences (good or bad) ordained by a Supreme Being. No "chance or coincidence" in traditional thought

MNEMONIC: SES = Social, Economic, Spiritual — the 3 dimensions of Traditional African Development

EXAM TIP: Breach of social order = WRATH OF THE GODS = hinders development. The idea of "chance or coincidence" was ALIEN to traditional Africa

1. The Political Institution — Overview

- Maintenance of law and order = MAJOR demand for traditional political power
- Two paramount systems: MONARCHICAL (kingdom) and NON-MONARCHICAL (republican/stateless)
- The nuclear family = smallest unit of social and political organisation
- Oldest male family member = head; controls political, economic affairs; custodian of family tradition
- Village = a STATE; each independent of the other; territorial independence

2. Songhai Empire — Government & Economy

Economy:

- Based on CLAN SYSTEM — clan determined occupation
- Most common occupations: metalworkers, fishermen, carpenters
- At top: noblemen and direct descendants of original Songhai people
- Julla (merchants) formed partnerships; state protected them and Niger port cities
- Independent gold fields central to regional economy
- Labour system resembled modern-day unions (craft guilds)

Government:

- Sonni Ali established government system; expanded by Askia Muhammad
- Governors and mayors appointed to preside over local tributary states
- Tax imposed on peripheral chiefdoms for Songhai dominance; provinces given almost complete autonomy
- Under Askia Muhammad: increased centralisation; encouraged learning in Timbuktu

3. Oyo Empire — Detailed Political Structure

Institution	Composition/Description	Function
Alaafin of Oyo	Supreme overlord; title means "owner of the palace"	Keep tributaries safe; settle disputes; mediate between sub-rulers and the empire
Oyomesi	7 principal councillors: Bashorun, Agbaakin, Samu, Alapini, Laguna, Akiniku, Ashipa	Electoral Council + Legislative powers (like US Congress); represented the people
Bashorun	Head of Oyomesi	Sort of Prime Minister; final say on new Alaafin nomination; consulted on major decisions
Ogboni	Powerful secret society of freemen noted for age and wisdom	Spoke for people backed by religion; judged cases involving spilling of blood
Oluwo	Leader of Ogboni	Unqualified right of direct access to Alaafin on any matter
Ilari	Religious/government officials (usually eunuchs); half-heads (half shaved)	Spies, tax collectors, guards, messengers. Titles: obal'olu, madarikan
Areemo	First-born prince (eldest son of Alaafin)	Quite powerful; often left palace. Historically sometimes hastened father's death

- Removing an Alaafin: Bashorun presents EMPTY CALABASH or PARROT'S EGG = sign he must commit suicide (only way to remove him since he cannot be legally deposed)
- Bashorun proclaims: "The gods reject you, the people reject you, the earth rejects you"
- Alaafin, his eldest son AND the Samu all commit suicide to renew government — during Orun festival

4 Layers of Oyo Empire:

- Metropolitan Oyo: Hub of empire; Yoruba spoke Oyo dialect; divided into 6 provinces
- Yorubaland: Towns closest to Oyo-Ile; tributary states led by their own Obas
- Egbado Corridor: SW of Yorubaland; guaranteed Oyo's trade with the coast; supervised by Ajele
- Ajaland: Most restive and distant territory; extended into modern Togo

MNEMONIC: MOY-EA = Metropolitan Oyo, Yorubaland, Egbado Corridor, Ajaland (4 layers from centre outward)

4. Efik-Ibibio Political Institution

- Unit of political authority = EKPUK (extended family/lineage)
- Nucleus = Itibe Ekpuk (Royal Family)
- Founding family (Ekpuk) produces Okuku Obong Obio and Amanayabo
- Between founding family and lineage heads = Akpan Okuku — communicates between Okuku and lineage heads

- Akpan Okuku = president of village council; has executive, judicial and administrative powers
- Annang village system: No one can rise beyond lineage level (Ekpuk)
- Village council = Esopidung; main function is RELIGIOUS
- Obong Order = special class of royal members; ministers appointed from here
- Efik-Ibibio bond of lineage did NOT lie strictly in kinship/blood ties — diverse ancestry

5. Igbo Political Organisation

- Based on LINEAGE STRUCTURE; flexible democratic political systems
- Autonomous federations of lineages/villages organised through lineage heads, age-grades and title societies

5 Categories of Decision-Makers:

- 1st: Traditional archetype — decisions by consensus among lineage representatives (age, wealth, privilege)
- 2nd: Title societies + lineage elders = decision-making group (found among Awka Igbo)
- 3rd: Secret societies dominate (Cross River Igbo in Abriba, Ohafia, Arochukwu)
- 4th: Age grade and lineage heads form decision-making body (common in Asaba, Aguleri, Abriba)
- 5th: Hierarchical political structure (Niger Igbo — Ogbani, Oguta Abo, Onitsha, Osomari)

Age Grade Roles:

- OLDEST grade: co-opted into village council; administers oaths, offers sacrifices, initiates males into secret cults
- MIDDLE grade: successful business people; assists youths in military and social services
- LOWEST grade (children): public sanitation

Exclusive Clubs (Secret Societies):

- Ekpe = Leopard society | Ekpo = Ghost/masquerade society
- Each grade has peculiarities in dress, dance and rituals
- Ekpe/Ekpo = supreme authority for law and order; also insurance policy for members
- Igbo = masquerade (mmuo) club. Delta/Riverine areas = owu
- Both executive and masquerade clubs are EXCLUSIVELY FOR MEN

EXAM TIP: Ekpe = LEOPARD, Ekpo = GHOST. Secret societies = social control mechanism. Women play NO significant political/religious roles in traditional Igbo system

1. The Indigene/Settler Concept

- "Indigeneity" concept took root in Nigeria's 1979 constitution and lives on in the 1999 constitution
- System categorizes all Nigerians as: INDIGENES or NON-INDIGENES ("settlers") based on where their parents/grandparents were born
- Original intent: ensure ethnic parity in education and employment; protect traditional cultures
- In 2006: Human Rights Watch and International Crisis Group separately reported the principle has INSTEAD:
 - Systematically marginalized millions of Nigerians
 - Encouraged ethno-linguistic identity politics
 - Fanned flames of inter-communal violence
- Policy became tool to exclude "settlers" from educational, employment and political opportunities
- Nigeria divided into 36 states and 774 Local Government Areas since 1996

Plateau State Example:

- Indigeneity used by Christian politicians to exclude Muslim Hausa/Fulani "settlers"
- Jarawa ethnic group = "non-indigene" but also fails to qualify for indigenous status ANYWHERE else in Nigeria
- Since 1999 in Plateau State: intercommunal fighting → over 550,000 internally displaced persons
- April 2006: Pan vs. Gomai ethnic groups → 100+ killed, 8,000 displaced
- 2011: Entire villages massacred; women and children killed in their hundreds

2. Colonial History That Created This

Year	Event
1885	British claim to lands in today's Nigeria internationally recognized
1900	Nigeria administered as concession of Royal Niger Company
1906	Lagos Colony + Southern Protectorate merged
1914	All three units amalgamated = Colony and Protectorate of Nigeria
1939	Southern Protectorate split into Eastern and Western Provinces
1947	Nigeria divided into Northern, Eastern and Western regions — gave prominence to Hausa-Fulani (N), Igbo (E), Yoruba (W)
1954/1957	Federal + Constitutional conferences — minority problem became major political question

3. Causes of Indigene/Settler Crises in Nigeria

- Resource-Based (MAIN cause): Ethnicity used as tool by political elites in pursuit of state power and resources; flag of ethnicity flown in allocation of state resources and power sharing
- Primordial Loyalties: People feel physically safe and psychologically secured among their ancestral group; intrusion viewed with suspicion; resources are scarce
- Fear of Dominance: Fear of external imperialism; consciousness of dissimilarity. Evident in Hausa-Fulani vs. Vum peoples of Sango-Kataf in Plateau State
- Weak State Structure: Endemic poverty, winner-takes-all philosophy, institutional deficiencies propel inter-ethnic rivalry
- Imperialism & Colonialism: Colonial masters' systems of administration, arbitrary delimitation and partitioning created ethnic fault lines

MNEMONIC: RPFWI = Resources, Primordial loyalty, Fear of dominance, Weak state, Imperialism — 5 causes

EXAM TIP: Ethnicity = viable source of UNDERDEVELOPMENT and bad governance in Nigeria. The solution advocated = "power-sharing model" that promotes integration and cooperation

4. Notable Ethnic Conflicts in Nigeria

Key conflicts include: Jos, Umuleri/Aguleri, Ijaw/Itsekiri, Ife/Modakeke, Tiv/Jukun. African traditional alternatives to conflict resolution may remain imperative in the new millennium.

1. Social Mobility — Definition

Social mobility = movement of individuals, families, households or other categories of people within or between layers/tiers in an open system of social stratification.

- Refers to class, ethnic groups, political, religion or entire nation
- Measures: health status, literacy, education, income/economic status
- Vertical mobility: movement UP or DOWN socio-economic levels (by change in jobs, marriage, positions)
- Horizontal movement: from one position to another WITHIN the same social level
- Absolute social mobility: overall numbers of people who end up in a different layer from their parents
- Relative social mobility: differences in probability of attaining a certain outcome, regardless of structural changes
- Barber's definition: movement (upward or downward) between higher or lower social classes; between one relatively full-time, functionally significant social role and another

2. Types/Classification of Mobility

Type	Definition	Example
Intra-generational	Change in social status WITHIN a single lifetime; personal development within a family over time	Last born of family who becomes breadwinner of entire household
Inter-generational	Change in status from PARENTS to CHILDREN's generation	Professor who is son of a school teacher
Vertical (Upward)	Movement UP the socio-economic scale; gaining properties, income, status	School teacher promoted to school principal
Vertical (Downward)	Movement DOWN the socio-economic scale; losing properties, income, status	Businessman who goes bankrupt
Horizontal	Movement across similar socio-economic positions; change of occupation or same occupation in different org/location	Minister of Education transferred to Finance Ministry; VC moving to another university
Lateral	Geographical movement between neighbourhoods, towns or regions; combines vertical and horizontal	Migration due to economic, religious or social reasons
Structural/Exchange	Forced vertical mobility from change in distribution of status within society; due to societal changes not individual effort	Declaration of "Free and Compulsory" secondary education

MNEMONIC: IIV-HLS = Intra, Inter, Vertical, Horizontal, Lateral, Structural — 6 types of mobility

3. Forms of Capital Enabling Mobility

Capital Type	Example
Information/Knowledge	Higher education
Human Capital	Competence and effort in labour
Social Capital	Support from one's social network
Physical Capital	Ownership of tools or means of production
Symbolic Capital	Worth of an official title, celebrity status

MNEMONIC: IHSPS = Information, Human, Social, Physical, Symbolic — 5 forms of capital

4. Factors Responsible for Social Mobility

1. Motivation: Desire to improve social standing. In capitalism, any status is achievable. Without motivation, mobility is impossible
2. Achievements and Failures: Remarkable achievements improve status (e.g. acquiring wealth, winning literary prize). Failures/misdeeds cause downward mobility (e.g. fraudulent bankruptcy = lose club membership, marriage prospects, peers)
3. Education: Knowledge passport for occupational positions of higher prestige. Minimum formal education required before individuals aspire to higher positions
4. Migration: People migrate due to pull/push factors. New places may offer different openings and opportunities
5. Industrialisation & Modernisation: Industrial Revolution: status based on ability/training (not caste/race/religion/ethnicity). Modernisation: use of scientific knowledge; secular way of life; low-prestige workers move to new occupations

MNEMONIC: MAEMI = Motivation, Achievements, Education, Migration, Industrialisation — 5 factors

5. Social Change

Social change = an alteration in the social order of a society. May refer to social progress/socio-cultural evolution, paradigmatic changes in socio-economic structure, or social revolutions (e.g. women's suffrage, civil rights movement).

- Driven by: cultural, religious, economic, scientific or technological forces
- May include change in nature, social institutions, social behaviour or social relations

Two Sources of Social Change:

- Random/Unique Factors: Climate, weather, presence of specific groups of people. Natural; mostly act of God
- Systemic Factors: Human factors. E.g. change from military to civilian rule (democracy), compulsory education, religious migration, infrastructural revolution, urbanisation, conflict

EXAM TIP: Social change ≠ social mobility. Change = alteration in SOCIETY. Mobility = movement of INDIVIDUALS/GROUPS within society

Key Dates to Memorise

Date	Event
11,000 BC	Earliest human habitation in Nigeria (Iwo-Eleru)
900 BC-200 AD	Nok Culture (Jos Plateau)
800 CE	Songhai settled at Gao
948 AD	Eri (founder of Nri) settled the region
1914	Amalgamation of Nigeria (Lugard); name "Nigeria" by Flora Shaw
1960	Independence (Oct 1)
1963	Federal Republic (Oct 1)
1966 Jan 17	First military coup
1967-1970	Nigerian Civil War (Biafra)
1979 Oct	2nd Republic (Shagari)
1983 Dec 31	Buhari military coup
1985 Aug 27	Babangida ousts Buhari
1993 June 12	Presidential election (Abiola won; annulled June 23)
1999 May 29	4th Republic begins (Obasanjo)
2007 May 29	Yar'Adua — first civilian-to-civilian transition
2010 May 5/6	Yar'Adua dies; Jonathan sworn in
2015	Buhari wins as civilian president

All Mnemonics Consolidated

Topic	Mnemonic
W1 - Culture vs Civilisation	CC = City & Cultivation
W1 - Nigeria basics	NAIL = Name, Amalgamation, Independence, Lagos→Abuja
W2 - Coat of Arms	EAGLE=Strength, SHIELD=Resources, Y-BAND=2 Rivers, HORSES=Dignity, GREEN=Agriculture, WHITE=Peace
W2 - Political history order	1960→1963→1966→1967-70→1979→1983→1985→1993→1999→2007
W3 - Empires	NOSoBN = Nok, Oyo, Songhai, Benin, Nri
W4 - Development dimensions	SES = Social, Economic, Spiritual
W5 - Oyo Empire layers	MOY-EA = Metropolitan, Yorubaland, Egbado, Ajaland
W6 - Causes of indigene/settler crisis	RPFWI = Resources, Primordial, Fear, Weak state, Imperialism
W7 - Types of mobility	IIV-HLS = Intra, Inter, Vertical, Horizontal, Lateral, Structural
W7 - Capital types	IHSPS = Information, Human, Social, Physical, Symbolic
W7 - Factors of mobility	MAEMI = Motivation, Achievements, Education, Migration, Industrialisation

Likely Exam Questions & Quick Answers

Q: What does the Y-shaped silver band in Nigeria's Coat of Arms represent? A: River Niger and River Benue (the two major rivers)
Q: What does the red eagle represent? A: Nigeria's strength
Q: What does the white stripe on the flag represent? A: Peace and unity; symbolic of Niger River bisecting the countryside

Q: Who suggested the name "Nigeria"?

A: Flora Shaw (British journalist), 1914

Q: Who merged Nigeria in 1914?

A: Sir Frederick Lugard (became first Governor-General)

Q: What is the Nok culture known for?

A: Earliest identified Nigerian culture; first life-sized terracotta figurines; iron smelting from 550 BC

Q: What is unique about the Kingdom of Nri?

A: Its leader exercised NO military power; expanded through converts not force

Q: What is the Oyomesi?

A: 7 principal councillors of Oyo Empire with electoral and legislative powers (like US Congress)

Q: How was an Alaafin removed from power?

A: Bashorun presents parrot's egg/empty calabash = Alaafin must commit suicide (cannot be legally deposed)

Q: What does Ekpuk mean?

A: Lineage or extended family (unit of political authority among Efik-Ibibio and Annang)

Q: When did Nigeria gain independence?

A: October 1, 1960

Q: When did Nigeria become a Federal Republic?

A: October 1, 1963

Q: What triggered the first military coup?

A: January 15, 1966 (the coup that ended the 1st Republic)

Q: What was the "War Against Indiscipline" (WAI)?

A: Anti-indiscipline campaign launched by Buhari's administration (1983-1985)

Q: What is social mobility?

A: Movement of individuals/families within or between layers in an open system of social stratification

Q: Difference between intra and inter-generational mobility?

A: Intra = within single lifetime. Inter = change from parents to children's generation

Q: What are the 3 dimensions of development in traditional Africa?

A: Social/Moral, Economic, Spiritual/Personal

Q: How was peace promoted in traditional African societies?

A: Village square meetings, Kings' yard meetings, sharing palm wine in same calabash, breaking/sharing kola nuts

Q: Main cause of indigene/settler crisis?

A: Resource-based: ethnicity used as political tool in pursuit of state power and resources

Q: What is Askia the Great known for?

A: Successor of Sonni Ali; brought Islam to influence Songhai Empire; increased centralization; encouraged learning in Timbuktu

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INDIGENE — FUOYE Nursing Student, Future Neuropsychiatric Nurse & Web Developer